

KITAIBELA

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SYN. KITAIBELIA

MALVACEAE

Genus of one species of summer-flowering perennial. Needs full sun and fertile, moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall or spring.

K. vitifolia. Bushy, upright perennial. H to 5ft (1.5m), S 2ft (60cm). In summer bears small clusters of open cup-shaped, white or rose-pink flowers. Has palmately lobed, coarsely toothed leaves. Z6–8

Kitaibelia. See *Kitaibela*.
Kitchingia uniflora. See *Kalanchoe uniflora*.
Kleinia articulata. See *Curio articulata*.

KNAUTIA

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering annuals and perennials. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Requires staking. Propagate by basal cuttings in spring or seed in spring or fall.
K. arvensis, syn. *Scabiosa arvensis* (Scabious). Erect perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 1½ft (45cm). Bears heads of pincushion-like, bluish-lilac flowers in summer. Stems are clothed in narrowly ovate to lyre-shaped, deeply divided leaves. Z5–9
K. macedonica, syn. *Scabiosa rumelica*, illus. p.235.

KNIGHTIA

PROTEACEAE

Genus of evergreen, summer-flowering trees or shrubs, grown for their flowers, foliage and overall appearance. Grow in fertile, well-drained soil, in sun or partial shade. Water containerized specimens moderately in growth, less in winter. Propagate by seed in spring.
K. excelsa (New Zealand honeysuckle, Rewa rewā). Evergreen, upright tree. H 70ft (20m) or more, S 6–12ft (2–4m). Has oblong to lance-shaped, coarsely serrated, leathery leaves, glossy and deep green. Dense racemes of slender, tubular, deep red flowers are produced in summer. Z10–11 (min. 37–45°F/3–7°C)

KNIPHOFIA

Red-hot poker, Torch lily

ASPHODELACEAE/LILIACEAE

Genus of perennials, some of which are evergreen. Needs full sun and well-drained soil that is constantly moist in summer. Propagate species by seed or division in spring, cultivars by division only in spring. See also feature panel p.254.
K. ‘Alcazar’. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 1½ft (45cm). Has long, lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright, dark green stems bear racemes of reddish-orange buds opening to tubular, golden-yellow flowers. Z7–11
K. ‘Bee’s Lemon’. Upright perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 1½ft (45cm). Grasslike, deep green leaves have serrated edges. Bears dense, terminal racemes of tubular, green-tinged, citron-yellow flowers on sturdy stems in late summer and fall. Z6–9

K. ‘Bees’ Sunset’ (illus. p.254). Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 1½ft (45cm). Has long, grasslike, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright, purplish-green stems bear slender racemes of tubular, warm orange-flushed, yellow flowers. Z6–9
K. ‘Brimstone’. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 1½ft (45cm). Has long, narrowly lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright stems bear slender racemes of tubular, soft greenish-yellow flowers. Z6–11
K. caulescens (illus. p.254). Stately, evergreen, upright perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Has basal tufts of narrow, blue-green leaves and smooth, sturdy stems bearing terminal spikes of reddish-salmon flowers in fall. Z6–9
K. ‘C.M. Prichard’ of gardens. See *K. rooperi*.

K. ‘Cobra’. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m) or more, S 1½ft (45cm). Has long, lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright stems bear sturdy, broad, dense racemes of tubular, brown-tinged, orange flowers that age to yellowish-white. Z6–11
K. ‘Green Jade’ (illus. p.254). Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 22in (55cm). Has long, lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright stems produce elegant, slender racemes of tubular, pale green flowers, fading to warm ivory-white. Z6–9
K. ‘Ice Queen’ (illus. p.254). Robust, clump-forming, herbaceous perennial. H 5ft (1.5m), S 2½ft (75cm). Bears green-budded flowers opening to pale primrose yellow, fading to ivory, in midsummer. Z6–11
K. linearifolia. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 5ft (1.5m), S 32in (80cm). Has very long, rather lax, grasslike, mid-green leaves. In summer, upright stems bear dense racemes of orange-red buds opening to tubular, bright yellow flowers. Z7–11
K. ‘Little Maid’. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 1ft (30cm). Has long, grasslike, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright stems bear racemes of tubular, greenish-yellow flowers that fade to creamy-white. Z6–9
K. ‘Nancy’s Red’. Herbaceous perennial with grasslike leaves. H 28in (70cm), S 18in (45cm). Produces heads of red flowers in midsummer. Z6–11
K. ‘Nobilis’, syn. *K. uvaria* ‘Nobilis’. Upright, evergreen perennial. H 5–6ft (1.5–2m), S 3ft (1m). Bears broad racemes of rich orange-red flowers, fading to yellow, in midsummer. Z7–11
K. northiae. Evergreen, rosette-forming perennial. H 5ft (1.5m), S 3ft (1m) or more. Has rather lax, broadly strap shaped, pointed, pale green leaves. In summer produces dense racemes of tubular, greenish-yellow flowers. Z7–11
K. ‘Percy’s Pride’ illus. p.251.
K. ‘Prince Igor’ (illus. p.254). Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 6ft (2m) or more, S 3ft (1m). Has long, lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright stems bear racemes of tubular, yellow-tinged, reddish-orange flowers. Z6–9
K. rooperi, syn. *K. ‘C.M. Prichard’* of gardens (illus. p.254). Robust, evergreen

perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 2ft (60cm). Has arching, linear, dark green leaves. From early to late fall, produces broadly ellipsoid racemes of orange-red flowers, becoming orange-yellow. Z6–9
K. ‘Royal Standard’ (illus. p.254). Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m) or more, S 22in (55cm). Bears long, lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright stems bear 2-toned racemes of bright red buds opening to tubular, yellow flowers. Z6–9
K. ‘Samuel’s Sensation’. Semi-evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 5½ft (1.6cm) or more, S 32in (80cm). Bears long, lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright stems bear racemes of tubular, pinkish-red flowers aging to orange-yellow. Z6–9
K. ‘Strawberries and Cream’. Largely herbaceous, rather compact, clump-forming perennial. H 2ft (60cm), S 14in (35cm). Has lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, bears upright racemes of tubular, pinkish-ivory flowers, opening from darker buds. Z6–10
K. ‘Tawny King’ (illus. p.254). Largely herbaceous, clump-forming perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 3ft (90cm). Produces brownish-orange buds, opening to cream flowers on bronzed stems, from midsummer to early fall. Z6–11
K. ‘Tetbury Torch’. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 1½ft (45cm). Has lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In early summer and often in later summer bears erect racemes of tubular, orange flowers, fading to warm yellow. Z6–11
K. thomsonii var. *thomsonii* ‘Stern’s Trip’. Stoloniferous perennial, deciduous in cold areas. H to 4½ft (1.4m), S 1½ft (45cm). Forms tufts of upright, linear leaves. From midsummer to late fall, bears a succession of curved, yellowish-orange flowers, to 2ft (60cm) long. Z6–10
K. ‘Timothy’. Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 1½ft (45cm). Has long, lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright, purplish-green stems bear racemes of tubular, warm peachy-pink flowers. Z6–11
K. ‘Toffee Nosed’ (illus. p.254). Semi-evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 1½ft (45cm). Has long, lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, erect stems bear racemes of tubular, brown-orange flowers, fading to warm cream. Z6–11
K. uvaria ‘Nobilis’. See *K. ‘Nobilis’*.
K. ‘Wrexham Buttercup’ (illus. p.254). Semievergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 4ft (1.2m), S 22in (55cm). Has long, lance-shaped, mid-green, basal leaves. In summer, upright stems bear broad racemes of tubular, bright yellow flowers, opening from greenish buds. Z6–9

Kochia. See *Bassia*.

KOELREUTERIA

SAPINDACEAE

Genus of deciduous, summer-flowering trees or shrubs, grown for their foliage, flowers and fruits. Unripened wood is susceptible to frost damage. Requires full sun, doing best in hot summers, and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by

seed in fall or by root cuttings in late winter.
K. paniculata (Golden rain tree, Pride of India) illus. p.89. **‘Coral Sun’** is a spreading tree, H 12ft (4m), S 10ft (3m), with reddish shoots, and leaf stalks with fernlike, orange-pink young leaves, maturing to fresh green, before turning orange and yellow in fall. Slow-growing, but can be pollarded to produce vigorous, more colorful young growth. Z6–9

KOHLERIA

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of erect perennials and subshrubs with scaly rhizomes, grown for their showy, tubular flowers. Grow in moist but well-drained soil and in full sun or semishade. Water sparingly in winter; over-watering will cause rhizomes to rot. Propagate in spring by division of rhizomes or by seed if available.
K. amabilis. Erect to prostrate, rhizomatous perennial. H and S 2ft (60cm). Ovate, scalloped, hairy leaves, to 3in (8cm) long, are often marked with silver and brown above. Small, nodding, tubular, deep pink flowers, with red-marked lobes, are borne in summer. Z14–15. **var. bogotensis** (syn. *K. ‘Bogotensis’*) is erect with velvety, green leaves, sometimes marked paler green above. Red-and-yellow flowers, with mouths spotted red, are borne from fall to early winter.
K. ‘Bogotensis’. See *K. amabilis* var. *bogotensis*.
K. digitaliflora. See *K. warszewiczii*.
K. eriantha illus. p.470.
K. warszewiczii, syn. *K. digitaliflora*, illus. p.469.

KOLKWITZIA

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of one species of deciduous shrub, grown for its abundant flowers. Prefers full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Cut out old shoots after flowering. Propagate by softwood cuttings in summer.
K. amabilis (Beauty bush). Deciduous, arching shrub. H and S 10ft (3m). Has peeling bark and ovate, dark green leaves. Bears bell-shaped, yellow-throated, white or pink flowers in late spring and early summer. Z5–9. **‘Pink Cloud’** illus. p.114.

Korolkowia sewerzowii. See *Fritillaria sewerzowii*.

KUMARA

ASPHODELACEAE / ALOEACEAE

Genus of perennial succulents that gradually develop a shrubby, branched, corky trunk with age. Grown for their strap-shaped leaves, which are arranged in opposing rows like a folded fan. Requires free-draining compost. Propagate by seed sown in spring.
K. plicatilis, syn. *Aloe plicatilis*. Perennial succulent with leaves in a fan-shape on branching stems. H and S to 2ft (60cm). Strap-shaped, smooth, dull to glaucous green leaves have minutely toothed margins. In summer, unbranched flower stems, to 20in (50cm) long, produce cylindrical spikes of bell-shaped, scarlet flowers, 2in (5cm) long. Z11 (min. 41°F/5°C)